Tit4Tat Trading Bot: presenter script

5-minute talk, 8 slides, about 650 words. The same text is in the deck's speaker notes (Presenter View).

Slide 1 · Tit4Tat Trading Bot

~20 s

Hi, we are team Tit4Tat. In the next five minutes we'll show you a trading bot that runs on its own. It reads the live market stream, decides once per simulated day, and places its own orders through the platform. Every decision it makes comes with a written reason, so you can audit any trade.

Slide 2 · Grow ₹10 lakh in a live market, after tax

~35 s

The challenge: every team starts with ten lakh rupees of virtual cash. Market prices and news stream in live over Kafka, and the clock runs fast, about one trading day every four seconds, so a human can't trade it by hand.

The score is wealth after real fees and Indian capital-gains tax. The platform also enforces strict rules: heartbeats in pre-flight, and a limit on how many requests you can send.

Slide 3 · How the bot decides, every simulated day

~45 s

Each simulated day goes through the same five steps.

The bot **listens** until all 40 prices for the day are in. It **measures** each stock with standard indicators, a volume-flow signal and a news score. It **ranks** them, and the risk guard can reduce or block buying if we're in a drawdown. Then it **plans** up to ten orders.

Every order is checked against our cash and the platform's rules before it's sent, so bad orders never reach the exchange. The whole decision takes about 400 milliseconds, and every order is logged with a plain-English reason.

Slide 4 · Own the strongest stocks, keep the tax low

~45 s

The strategy has four parts.

One: out of 40 stocks we hold the best 10, ranked by volume flow, which tells us whether buyers or sellers are in control.

Two: we don't buy everything on day one. A stock is bought when buyers lead, and anything still waiting is bought by day 20.

Three: we hold winners through normal dips, cap any single stock at 30 percent, and the risk guard slows buying in a drawdown.

Four: tax is part of the score. So we use the one-lakh tax-free long-term gain every year, and book losses to cancel out taxable gains.

Slide 5 · 30+ experiments: we kept only what won

~45 s

We didn't guess at the strategy. We back-tested every idea over 32 overlapping 500-day games, with fees and tax included.

Popular profit-taking rules, like RSI exits, trailing stops and rebalancing, all lost 23 to 34 points against our final strategy, because they sell the big winners too early.

Weighting by volume flow raised the share of games that beat buy-and-hold from 12.5 to 56 percent.

We also tested whether news headlines predict the next day's price. They don't, so news is logged and explained but never triggers a trade on its own.

Slide 6 · Pre-flight test: +107.9% vs the market's +81.5%

~45 s

This is the official pre-flight test on the platform, on 40 stocks the bot had never seen before.

After 1,008 trading days, ten lakh grew to 20.79 lakh, up 107.9 percent. Simply holding all 40 stocks made 81.5 percent. It peaked at 31.1 lakh in November 2021.

To be honest about risk: in the 2022 sell-off it fell 41 percent from that peak, along with the market.

140 orders were filled. The 2 rejections were short trades the platform had already closed by itself; the bot synced with the server and carried on.

Slide 7 · Built to run unattended

~40 s

No one touches the bot during the game, so we built it to recover on its own.

96 automated tests cover the strategy, tax and failure cases. A request pacer keeps us under the platform's rate limit. A watchdog reconnects to the Kafka stream if it stalls; that happened in a live run, and it recovered by itself.

Heartbeats are retried through server timeouts, our records are checked against the server, and the access token never leaves the .env file.

Slide 8 · What we learned

~35 s

Three lessons.

First, patience pays: holding strong stocks beat every clever exit rule we tested.

Second, volume shows who is in control, and that picked better stocks than price alone.

Third, tax is part of the return: using the tax-free allowance and booking losses costs nothing and keeps more profit.

Our next step is softening deep drawdowns like 2022 without selling the winners. Thank you; we're happy to take questions.

Tips

- If you're running short on time, shorten slides 5 and 7 first. The result on slide 6 is the slide judges will remember.
- Check the final number on the website before you present. If the official score differs from ₹20.79 L, say the website's number.